Brewing a Success Story

Vaniitha Jaiin was just six when she lost her father. Along with her mother, elder brother and younger sister, she was forced to leave their hometown of Ambasamudram in Tamil Nadu and relocate to Bengaluru. Coming from a small town to a metropolis in a different state meant early days in her new school were difficult, but Vaniitha soon excelled in sports, dance and studies at Aurobindo Memorial School. "My siblings and I were on a journey where we had to earn our tomorrow," she recalls.

Even before she entered college—first at Sri Bhagawan Mahaveer Jain College and, later, Jyoti Nivas College, where she studied for a management degree, Vaniitha began giving tuitions and selling clothes at summer camps when she was merely 13. By the time she turned 19, she had graduated to selling life insurance products. "This was not seen as 'OK' for a girl coming from a conservative North Indian Marwari family, who had lost her father. But I was a rebel for all the right reasons," says Vaniitha. It gave her enough pocket money to experience the taste of premium tea and coffee, helping develop her refined sense of how beverages are harvested, brewed and appreciated.

Later in her career, stints at companies such as O&M, Flipkart and Adecco exposed Vaniitha to some of the sharpest brand and marketing environments. But she was looking for something else. In 2010, at the height of a successful corporate career and with a one-and-a-half-year-old son, Vaniitha took an entrepreneurial leap. An advanced course in luxury brand management at ESSEC Business School in Paris sparked an unexpected fascination. "The word 'wine' literally whispered itself into my ears," she says, a curiosity that led her to the world of wines and spirits. She went to London and Paris to train, a learning journey that continued till 2022. Along the way, she launched her consultancy, The Perfect Pour, in 2015. She also rode solo across France's wine regions from north to south, shadowed master distillers, and judged international spirits competitions in China, Europe and the UK.

HER ADVICE

"Invest first in creating a great product. Invest in research, ingredients, craftsmanship and people who understand the liquid. Branding may encourage someone to pick up the bottle for the first time, but only a great product will bring them back"

The consultancy led to assignments with the Taj Group, Four Seasons and other leading hospitality brands. "I figured out that India is a hardcore spirits market," Vaniitha says. And, in 2023, she set up her own distillery in Goa's forested Sattari region, becoming India's first woman to own and build an alcobev distillery. In 2025, she launched Vanaha, her first product, a gin. Work-



WHAT MAKES HER A SHERO

A mother to a young child then, Vaniitha quit corporate life in 2010 to plunge into entrepreneurship, becoming India's first woman to own and build an alcoholic beverage distillery in the process